

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Detection Engineering | SIEM | Threat Response

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security analyst with over five years of experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) operations, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, detection logic development, and incident response. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring strong hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel (including Kusto Query Language (KQL) development), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook design. In my current and previous senior roles at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I have led threat detection, threat hunting, and incident response across an 8,000-user environment, building and refining detection rules, automating alert response workflows, and communicating complex security findings to stakeholders at all levels. I am equally comfortable working independently and advising internal customers, which has prepared me to contribute meaningfully to a managed detection and response environment where clear threat analysis and customer communication are essential to service quality.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL authoring, detection rule development, log source onboarding, workbooks); CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; Splunk (SPL queries, dashboards)
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Discover (proactive threat hunting, indicator sweeping); detection engineering aligned to MITRE ATT&CK framework
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook design and automation in Microsoft Sentinel; PowerShell-based alert enrichment and response automation
- **Incident Response and Threat Mitigation:** NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle (detection, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review); MITRE ATT&CK-aligned adversary kill chain analysis
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover (Expert); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Tanium
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; risk-based remediation workflows
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell (security orchestration, log analysis, automated reporting); KQL (advanced threat hunting and detection in Microsoft Sentinel)
- **Email and Endpoint Security:** Mimecast, Microsoft 365 Defender, Intune MDM/MAM, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Security Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer - University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead security operations and detection engineering across an 8,000-user estate using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platforms, maintaining continuous detection coverage across endpoint, identity, cloud, and email attack surfaces.
- Author and maintain KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, developing custom analytics rules, hunting queries, and workbooks aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Analyse detections and alerts from SOC tools including SIEM, EDR, and email security platforms; investigate, triage, and escalate confirmed threats with clear, stakeholder-ready analysis and remediation recommendations.

- Lead threat mitigation efforts and post-incident remediations, coordinating containment actions across endpoint, identity, and cloud layers and producing post-incident reviews with root cause analysis and lessons learned.
- Design and implement SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel and via PowerShell automation, streamlining alert enrichment, automated containment actions, and escalation workflows to improve SOC efficiency and reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Discover, applying MITRE ATT&CK kill chain analysis to search for indicators of compromise (IOC) and tactics, techniques and procedures (TTP) across the endpoint fleet.
- Oversee vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), translating scan results into risk-prioritised remediation cycles and providing cyber risk advisory to asset owners and senior management.
- Deliver expert cyber security guidance and advisory to internal stakeholders, communicating complex threat scenarios, risk exposure, and recommended controls in clear, accessible language.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID identity security, including Conditional Access policy management, MFA enforcement, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and investigation of identity-based threats using Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Sentinel signals.
- Ensure smooth operation of SOC processes by maintaining runbooks, detection playbooks, and escalation procedures; mentor junior analysts and provide technical guidance on investigation methodologies.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity - University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed daily SIEM alert triage and investigation using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, applying KQL hunting queries to analyse event data from Microsoft 365, Entra ID, endpoint, and network log sources.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting in CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Discover, identifying and containing threats including credential compromise, lateral movement, ransomware precursors, and fileless malware behaviours.
- Created and refined SIEM detection rules and correlation logic aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, improving alert fidelity and reducing false positive volumes.
- Led threat mitigation and post-attack remediation activities, working with infrastructure and endpoint teams to contain, eradicate, and recover from security incidents, and documenting root cause and lessons learned in post-incident reports.
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate alert enrichment, indicator lookups, and repetitive SOC tasks, reducing manual analyst workload and accelerating triage decisions.
- Managed vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus; produced risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracked findings to closure with asset owners.
- Operated Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) for alert investigation, device isolation, and live response; managed Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to detect identity-based attack patterns including pass-the-hash and lateral movement.
- Administered Mimecast email security gateway, investigating phishing campaigns and business email compromise (BEC) attempts, blocking threats, and coordinating with end users on suspected malicious content.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 gap assessments and Cyber Essentials Plus certification, producing control evidence and updating security documentation across access management, patch management, and malware protection domains.
- Communicated complex security findings and incident timelines to non-technical stakeholders, translating threat actor behaviour into actionable business risk language.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure - HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

- Monitored security events using SIEM tooling, escalating confirmed incidents to senior security staff and assisting with initial investigation, log collection, and containment steps.
- Administered Microsoft Active Directory, Group Policy Objects (GPO), and identity lifecycle processes, supporting a SaaS fintech product environment with strict access controls.

- Contributed to infrastructure security hardening aligned to CIS Controls, documenting security baselines and supporting vulnerability remediation activities.
- Managed Microsoft 365 security configurations including Exchange Online Protection (EOP) policies and SharePoint access controls, reducing exposure to email-based threats.
- Supported vulnerability scanning activities, assisting with the identification and prioritisation of remediation actions across the technology estate.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed and deployed a comprehensive library of KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, improving threat coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud attack surfaces at UAL.
- Built and operationalised SOAR-driven automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel and PowerShell, automating alert enrichment, IOC lookups, and initial containment responses, materially reducing SOC analyst workload on repetitive detections.
- Conducted threat hunting campaigns using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Discover across the 8,000-user endpoint estate, proactively identifying and containing advanced persistent threat (APT)-style behaviours before they escalated to confirmed incidents.
- Led complex incident response investigations from initial detection through containment, eradication, and recovery, applying NIST SP 800-61 methodology and MITRE ATT&CK kill chain analysis to produce actionable post-incident reports for senior leadership.
- Operationalised a Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme alongside Tenable.io vulnerability scanning, enabling continuous risk identification and evidence-based prioritisation of remediation work across the estate.
- Supported the delivery of UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification, producing technical evidence across five control domains and coordinating with infrastructure teams to remediate identified gaps within agreed timelines.
- Communicated threat intelligence findings, incident timelines, and risk posture assessments to senior stakeholders and non-technical audiences, translating complex adversary behaviours into clear, actionable recommendations.

EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.) - Environmental and Resource Engineering
- Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) - Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)